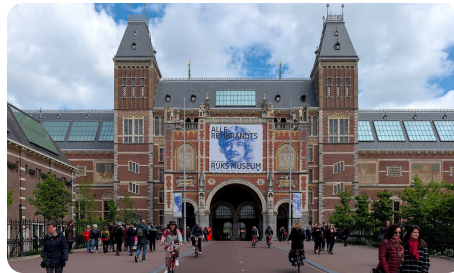




🇫🇷 → 🇳🇱 **Day 14 · Tuesday, Sep 1, 2026 · PARIS → AMSTERDAM**
(Eurostar) + Amsterdam afternoon

Prepared for Divyansh · Pure-Vegetarian Edition · Europe 2026



Solo · Pure vegetarian (no meat, no fish, no seafood, egg avoided) **Sarthak** is in Amsterdam Sep 1–5 — natural first meet-up tonight.

Snapshot: Early checkout → 2-min walk to Gare du Nord → **Eurostar 07:14 → 10:50 Amsterdam Centraal** (direct, ~3h36) → drop bags → Foodhallen lunch → canal belt / Nine Streets / Jordaan / Begijnhof / Bloemenmarkt / 't Smalle → dinner → Red Light District evening walk.

🕒 **WHEN TO WAKE / LEAVE — tight morning, read tonight**

Time	Action
05:45	Wake. Pack the last bits (everything else packed last night). Eurostar mornings punish stragglers.
~06:15	Checkout from the hostel (right next to Gare du Nord). Grab passport, phone, charger.

Time	Action
~06:20	Head to Gare du Nord — a 2-minute walk (hostel is beside the station). Walking beats waiting for a car at this hour; Uber ~€12–15 only if heavy trolley + rain.
~06:15–06:20	Arrive at the station ~55–60 min before departure. Go to the Eurostar terminal (signposted, upper level). Security/bag scan only.
06:20–07:00	Security scan → departure lounge → watch the board for your boarding gate.
~07:00	Gate opens → walk to the platform → board.
07:14	 Departure. Do not be late — Eurostar does not wait.

Golden rule: if anything feels tight, skip hostel breakfast — buy coffee + pastry in the lounge or eat packed veg snacks on the train.

EUROSTAR — BOOKED · QR ready · how to use it

Detail	Value
Depart	07:14 · Paris Gare du Nord
Arrive	10:50 · Amsterdam Centraal
Duration	~3h36 · direct (no change)
Class	Standard

Step by step:

1. **Have the QR/e-ticket ready in the Eurostar app** (plus a screenshot backup) *before* you reach the station — French station wifi is flaky at 6am.
2. **Arrive ~55–60 min early** — this Eurostar has airport-style **security + a boarding gate that closes ~10 min before departure**. Not a hop-on regional train.
3. Scan **QR at the ticket gate** → bag through security → departure lounge.
4.  **NO passport control — Paris→Amsterdam is Schengen-INTERNAL** (that's a domestic-style border; passport control is only on the *London* Eurostar). Keep your passport handy anyway, but expect **no stamp, no queue**.
5. Watch the board for the **platform + boarding gate**, then board and find your seat (coaches numbered along the platform).
6. **Onboard:** weak free wifi, power socket at seat, luggage racks at coach ends + overhead — keep your trolley in sight. **No checked baggage — you carry everything.**

7. **Amsterdam Centraal 10:50** — step off, walk out the front of the grand 1889 station straight onto the water. No passport control on arrival either.

HOUR-BY-HOUR — Sep 1

Time	Activity	Notes / Why
07:14	 Eurostar departs Paris	Download offline Amsterdam Google Map + HappyCow before the French signal drops.
~08:00	Onboard breakfast	Eat packed veg food or buy from the trolley (veg options limited — carry your own to be safe).
10:50	 Arrive Amsterdam Centraal	Iconic waterfront station. Set up transport below.
10:55–11:15	Exit → OVpay tap on a tram, or walk to the hostel	Central hostel is walkable from most of the centre.
~11:20	Check in / drop bags	If the room isn't ready, leave the trolley in luggage storage — the city is fully doable bag-free.
11:45–12:15	Tram/walk to Foodhallen (Bellamyplein 51)	Indoor food hall — veg-friendly first meal.
12:15–13:15	 Lunch at Foodhallen	Refuel; you'll walk ~7–9 km today.
13:30–14:30	 Canal belt + De 9 Straatjes (Nine Streets)	The UNESCO 17th-c canal ring (Herengracht, Keizersgracht, Prinsengracht) — the postcard Amsterdam.
14:30–15:30	Jordaan neighbourhood wander	The prettiest, most village-like quarter: narrow lanes, hidden hofjes (courtyards), galleries, flower boxes.
15:30–16:00	 Brown café 't Smalle (Egelantiersgracht 12)	1780s canal-side terrace — sit canalside with a coffee/juice, pure Amsterdam atmosphere.
16:15–16:45	 Begijnhof (entrance off Spui)	Hidden 14th-c courtyard of former lay-sisters' houses + Amsterdam's oldest wooden house (~1420). Free . Be quiet — people still live here. Closes ~17:00, so time it.
16:45–17:15	Bloemenmarkt (Singel canal)	The world's only floating flower market — tulip bulbs, souvenirs. Quick stroll.
17:15–18:30	Free time / relax / meet Sarthak	Great window to link up (he's here Sep 1–5). Or join a free walking tour to meet fellow travellers.
18:45–20:00	 Dinner — The Vegan Indian (or De Bolhoed)	See food. Familiar, hearty veg after a travel day.
20:15–21:30	 Red Light District (De Wallen) evening walk	Oldest part of the city, medieval lanes, canals lit at night, the Oude Kerk.  NO photos of the workers in windows — forbidden, enforced hard.

Time	Activity	Notes / Why
~21:30	Back to hostel / nightcap with Sarthak	Rest — museum day tomorrow starts at 09:00.

Why these spots

- **Canal belt / Nine Streets** — the UNESCO Golden-Age canal ring is why Amsterdam looks like Amsterdam; Nine Streets packs the best independent shops and cafés into nine tiny cross-streets. Slow wandering beats any checklist.
- **Jordaan** — the city's most atmospheric neighbourhood: hidden almshouse courtyards (hofjes), galleries, locals-only cafés. Where you *feel* Amsterdam.
- **'t Smalle** — a genuine "brown café" (bruin café = wood-panelled pub) from the 1780s with a floating canal terrace.
- **Begijnhof**  — a serene walled 14th-century courtyard hidden in plain sight, with the oldest wooden house in the city. Free, tranquil, easy to walk past. A highlight.
- **Bloemenmarkt** — the only floating flower market in the world; quick look + tulip-bulb souvenirs (buy "certified for import" packs if bringing home).
- **Red Light District** — beyond the obvious, it's the oldest, most beautiful medieval core around the Oude Kerk, best as an evening canal-lit walk.

TRANSPORT — Sep 1

- **Eurostar** Paris Gare du Nord → **Amsterdam Centraal** (details above). You arrive right in the centre — no airport transfer.
- **Within Amsterdam:** trams + metro + buses — just **TAP a contactless card/phone (OVpay)** when you board *and again when you get off* (tap out or you're overcharged). No paper tickets needed. **Trams 2 and 12** run from Centraal toward the Museumplein/Vondelpark side. A single ride is ~**€3.40** capped by OVpay.
- Amsterdam is **very walkable and bikeable** — most of today's sights are a compact walking loop; save the tram for the Foodhallen hop.
-  **Watch the bike lanes** — cyclists have priority and move fast; don't stand in the red-paved lanes.
- **Apps:** Citymapper / Google Maps (offline) for transit.

VEGETARIAN FOOD — Sep 1 (Amsterdam = Europe's best veg city)

- **Foodhallen** (Bellamyplein 51) — indoor food hall: **veg dim sum / bao, halloumi & falafel plates, Dutch cheese, wood-fired veg pizza, fresh juices**. Buzzy, social, perfect arrival lunch.
 - **The Vegan Indian** — 100% plant-based Indian: **dal makhani, chana masala, paneer-style tikka (vegan), biryani, naan/roti**. Comforting, familiar spices after a travel day.
 - **De Bolhoed** (Prinsengracht 60–62) — beloved veg/vegan canal-side institution: **veggie burritos, curries, big salads, homemade cakes**.
 - **Meatless District** — trendy fully plant-based: **jackfruit dishes, plant burgers, bowls, brunch plates**. (Good backup.)
 - **Tip: install HappyCow** — Amsterdam has dozens of all-veg spots; you rarely need to ask "is this veg?"
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💡 TIPS — Sep 1

- 🛂 **No passport control on this Eurostar** — it's a Schengen-internal border. Security scan only; no stamp. Still keep the passport handy.
 - ⚠️ **Red Light District: zero photos of the workers in windows** — locals/security enforce it hard. Keep the phone pocketed walking through De Wallen.
 - **Amsterdam is Europe's best vegetarian city** — you'll eat better here than anywhere on the trip. Be adventurous.
 - **Meet Sarthak** — he's in town Sep 1–5; tonight (dinner / Red Light walk) is the natural first meet-up.
 - **Free walking tour** (e.g. from Dam Square) is a great way to meet other solo travellers if Sarthak's busy.
 - **Tap OVpay contactless** on every tram — remember to tap **out**.
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🎬 Movies, Songs & Pop Culture Here (Bollywood + Hollywood)

Amsterdam intro today — the deep dive continues in Day-15 (the museum day). Points to notice on tonight's canal walk:

🎬 Hollywood

- **The Fault in Our Stars (2014)** — much of Hazel & Gus's romance unfolds along the **Amsterdam canals**. The famous bench sits on **Leidsegracht** (canal corner near the Nine Streets you're walking this afternoon), and their restaurant "Oranje" scene was filmed canal-side in the belt. You'll pass the exact water they drift along.

- **Ocean's Twelve (2004)** — the Clooney/Pitt heist crew regroups in Amsterdam; canal-house and coffee-shop scenes are set right in the central canal ring / Jordaan area you're wandering.

Bollywood

- **Queen (2013/2014)** — Kangana Ranaut's Rani has her whole liberating **Amsterdam** arc here after Paris: the canals, the hostel life, the bike rides, the coffee-shop misadventure. Since you're literally doing Paris→Amsterdam, you're retracing Rani's exact journey. Watch it on the train if you haven't.

(Full Amsterdam pop-culture list — with the museum-day spots — is in Day-15.)

 *Film-location thread runs through the trip · full repo: github.com/divyanshh/trip*